

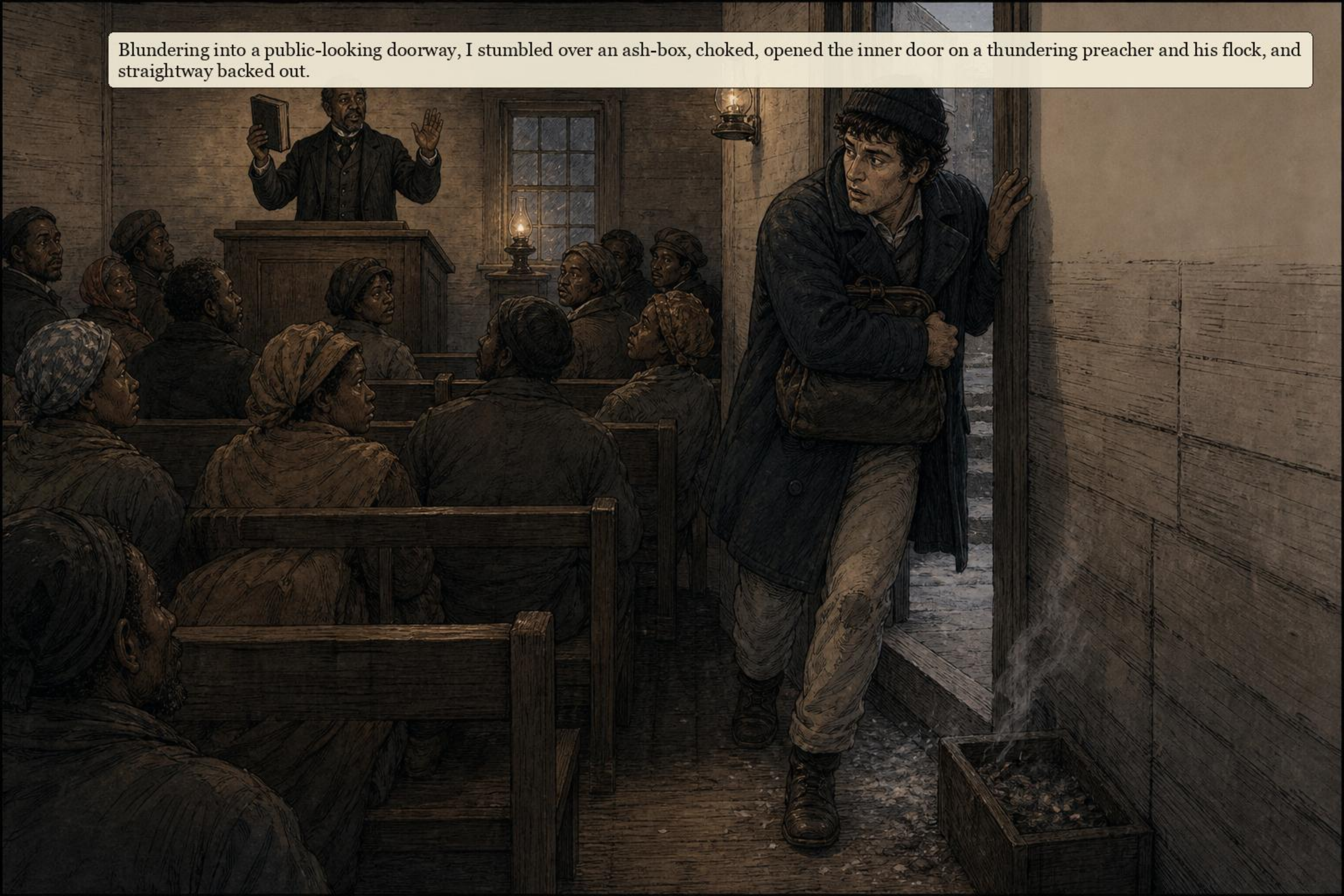
I reached New Bedford on a bitter Saturday night, only to hear the little packet for Nantucket had already sailed and none would go till Monday.



Sounding my pockets and finding only a few pieces of silver, I told myself to inquire the price and not be too particular where I lodged.



I left the Crossed Harpoons and the glowing Sword-Fish behind—too expensive and jolly—and turned waterward for cheaper inns.


Blundering into a public-looking doorway, I stumbled over an ash-box, choked, opened the inner door on a thundering preacher and his flock, and straightway backed out.

Then I saw the swinging sign with a tall jet of spray—ominous names or no—and judged this the very spot for cheap lodgings, so I made for the door.